Natural Resources Committee Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, April 6, 2026
4:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381190

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Glover called the meeting to order at 4:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair York Glover
Committee Vice-Chair Lawrence McElynn
Committee Member Dawson
Committee Member Tabernik
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Passiment
Council Member Mark Lawson

Absent
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Glover led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Glover stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:0

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Dawson, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve the minutes from February 3, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:0

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

7. Assistant County Administrator Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/381190

8. Agenda Items

a. An Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Ordinance Chapter 38 Environment, Article VII Green Space Program, Section 38-196 Method of Program and Procedures of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances. **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - County Attorney Brian Hulbert, Mark Davis, and Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of the Green Space Advisory Committee

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve an Ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Ordinance Chapter 38 Environment, Article VII Green Space Program, Section 38-196 Method.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:0

b. A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in unincorporated Jasper County known as the Chelsea Tracts (TMS# 081-00-02-001, 081-00-02-008 and 081-00-02-009), for the requested amount ($2,000,000) **(FISCAL IMPACT: $2,000,000 from the Green Space Program Fund Account #4706. Fund balance as of March 5, 2026 - $96,592,555. This is a grant and match is required.)** - Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of Green Space Advisory Committee & Mr. Mark Davis, Green Space Program Manager (10 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve a Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in unincorporated Jasper County known as the Chelsea Tracts (TMS# 081-00-02-001, 081-00-02-008 and 081-00-02-009), for the requested amount ($2,000,000).

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Tabernik to amend that we allocate the money equally among all the four regions.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion to amend passed 7:0

Main Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve a Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in unincorporated Jasper County known as the Chelsea Tracts (TMS# 081-00-02-001, 081-00-02-008 and 081-00-02-009), for the requested amount ($2,000,000) as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The main motion passed 7:0

c. A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in unincorporated Beaufort County known as the Victoria Bluff Tracts (PIN# R600 032 000 0002 0000, R600 032 000 0003 0000), for the requested amount ($7,470,000) **(FISCAL IMPACT: $7,470,000 from the Green Space Program Fund Account #4706. Fund balance as of March 5, 2026 - $96,592,555. This is a grant and match is required.)** - Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of the Green Space Advisory Committee & Mr. Mark Davis, Green Space Program Manager (10 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve a Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary and to provide funds to contribute to the procurement by the applicant, the Open Land Trust, for a conservation easement on property located in unincorporated Beaufort County known as the Victoria Bluff Tracts (PIN# R600 032 000 0002 0000, R600 032 000 0003 0000), for the requested amount ($7,470,000).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:0

d. Approval to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisition for the Green Space Program application Grangers Retreat Tracts **(FISCAL IMPACT: $35,000 from the Green Space Program Fund Account #4706. Fund balance as of March 5, 2026 - $96,592,555.)** - Mr. Mike McShane, Chair of Green Space Advisory Committee & Mr. Mark Davis, Green Space Program Manager (10 minutes).

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair McElynn to approve to fund due diligence and negotiate terms of acquisition for the Green Space Program application Grangers Retreat Tracts.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Tabernik, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 7:0

e. An Ordinance amending Chapter 38 Environment, Article VI Single Use Plastic Bags; Article VI Section 38-161 Purpose and Intent; Section 38-162 Definitions; Section 38-163 Regulations; Section 38-164 Exemptions; and Section 38-166 Effective Date and Review of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances. **(FISCAL IMPACT: No impact.)** - Rob Merchant, Director of Planning and Zoning & Juliana Zadik, Environmental Long Range Planner (10 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Ex-Officio Howard to approve an Ordinance amending Chapter 38 Environment, Article VI Single Use Plastic Bags; Article VI Section 38-161 Purpose and Intent; Section 38-162 Definitions; Section 38-163 Regulations; Section 38-164 Exemptions; and Section 38-166 Effective Date and Review of the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Glover, Committee Vice-Chair McElynn, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, and Committee Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Committee Member Tabernik, and Council Member Lawson. The motion passed 5:2.

9. Adjournment

Ratified: